

DECODED EXPLAINED

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Why is BRICS exploring cross-border payments?

Why is BRICS exploring cross-border payments?

How do cross-border payments work? What are the instructions between banks and costs involved in each step? How have transaction times reduced? Why does BRICS want to change the system? What alternatives are being explored? What does India propose?

Srinivasan Ramani

The story so far:
The 18th BRICS summit in New Delhi to be held in September, with India as the Chair, is expected to push for mechanisms to facilitate cross-border payments between members, including links between digital payment systems and central bank digital currencies (CBDCs), according to a report in *The Hindu businessLine*. Ahead of the summit, finance ministers' and central bank representatives from BRICS countries met in Jaipur on August 12-13 to discuss financial cooperation, payments, and the wider use of national currencies in settling trade between members.

How do current cross-border payments work?

Sending money from one country to another requires a chain of transactions. Let's say, an importer in Cape Town is buying passenger cars from an exporter in Chennai. The payment does not travel directly from the South African bank to the Indian one. It travels via a series of intermediaries called correspondent banks that hold accounts with each other. Since the South African bank does not hold an account with the Indian one (and vice versa), the payment is routed through a larger international bank that deals with both and is typically headquartered in London or New York. Because very few banks hold both rupees and rand, the payment involves converting rand to dollars and dollars to rupees where, in essence, the dollar acts like a vehicle currency, even though no American is involved in the trade.

What is SWIFT?

Now, apart from the money, there are also instructions that travel between the banks. This is handled by SWIFT (Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication), which

The 2024 BRICS report under Russia's chairmanship argued that this part of the financial system is monopolised by a single institution, raising transaction costs

is a Belgium-based cooperative and overseen by the National Bank of Belgium along with the G-10 central banks, including the U.S. Federal Reserve. SWIFT is a messaging network, like a secure post-office. It enables institutions to exchange payment instructions through it and settle amounts separately. It is used directly by more than 11,000 institutions in over 200 countries. Smaller banks reach it indirectly through larger banks that are part of the SWIFT network, which is why it has become crucial and hard to displace.

What are the costs involved in each step?

Every intermediary charges a fee and the currencies are converted twice (rand to dollar and dollar to rupees). So the foreign exchange margins are paid twice. A 2019 BRICS survey of cross-border payment systems, conducted by Brazil, found that Brazilian respondents reported foreign exchange margins of 2.5% with the figure rising to 8.5% for payments in Africa and, in some cases, as high as 20%.

While speed of transactions used to be a major issue, SWIFT claims that its SWIFT Global Payments Innovation has helped reduce transaction times significantly. Some structural delays remain even as the transaction chain has also become thinner. The Bank for International Settlements (BIS) found that active correspondent banking relationships fell by 20% between 2011 and 2018 with regional declines varying from 12% to 30% and Latin America being the worst affected. The reasons for this decline were largely commercial. Payment volumes kept growing during this period, even as they travelled through a smaller network.

Why does BRICS want to change this system?

For developing economies, though, payments in a handful of dominant currencies such as the U.S. dollar, the euro and the Japanese yen expose countries to the monetary policies of the countries that issue them. The 2024 BRICS report under Russia's chairmanship argued that this part of the financial system is monopolised by a single institution, raising transaction costs. Alternatives to the system suffer from the fact that they have to convince a large number of banks and regulators to join before being useful. A bank that uses an alternative system to deal with sanctioned entities – several Russian banks were cut off from SWIFT in 2022, following Russia's invasion of Ukraine – also risks sanctions, which deters others from joining. A sanctions hit Russia has pushed hardest for an alternative and is also the reason why others are wary of joining one.

What changes can be envisaged in the BRICS discussions?

The idea being explored is a payment system where, instead of payments moving through several correspondent banks with dollar conversions, national payment systems would connect to each other directly. This could be done in pairs as India and Singapore have already done for remittances by linking the former's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and the latter's PayNow systems. But building bilateral systems individually will not scale appropriately.

An alternative could be via a shared hub that each country joins. One such effort is Project Nexus, designed by the BIS and handed over to a company set up by six central banks, including India's Reserve Bank of India. It is set to go live only in 2027. Notably, it is not a BRICS initiative.

The BRICS discussions would extend this idea to the use of central bank digital currencies.

Here, central banks issue digital versions of their currencies for use between banks – a settlement asset, not the retail digital rupee held by individuals – and exchange them on a common platform. Both legs of a currency swap would occur at the same instant or not at all, removing the risk of paying out before the other side pays, which speeds up settlement and reduces the capital banks must set aside against such transactions.

The 2024 BRICS report claims transactions settled this way would yield significant cost savings. Only one such platform runs today – mBridge, built by the BIS with the central banks of China, Thailand, Hong Kong, and the UAE, which the BIS handed to its participants and left in October 2024. Over 95% of its settlement volume is in China's digital yuan, according to People's Bank of China figures reported by Reuters.

The Kazan declaration of BRICS in 2024 agreed to "discuss and study the feasibility" of an independent settlement system called BRICS Clear, but the Rio declaration the following year did not mention it.

What is India's position?

India's own proposal, reported in January, is that members link their CBDCs for trade and tourism payments. Indian officials have been careful to frame the payment systems as a means of cutting transaction costs and speeding up settlement rather than as initiatives to displace the dollar – even as Russian proposals, and those of some Brazilian economists, have gone further, towards alternative financial systems that would reduce dependence on the dollar. U.S. President Donald Trump, in November 2024, had threatened to impose 100% tariffs on BRICS countries if they moved away from the dollar and a further 10% tariff on countries aligning with vaguely defined "anti-American" BRICS policies during last year's Rio summit. The threats were not carried out. But even though they were not targeted at payment systems, this could perhaps be a reason why Indian officials have framed discussions only as a matter of reducing transaction costs.



PM Narendra Modi, Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva and South African President Cyril Ramaphosa at the BRICS Summit in Brazil in 2025. PTI

Why is BRICS exploring cross-border payments

- A Nostro Account refers to an account that a bank holds in a foreign country's bank in the currency of that country. The term “Nostro” is derived from Latin, meaning “our account with you.”
- Features of Nostro Account
 - It is maintained by a domestic bank in a foreign bank.
 - The account is held in the foreign country's currency.
 - It facilitates international trade and foreign exchange transactions.
 - Example of Nostro Account: If an Indian bank like State Bank of India maintains an account in a US bank in US dollars, that account is called a Nostro account for SBI.
- A Vostro Account is the opposite of a Nostro account. It refers to an account that a foreign bank holds in a domestic bank in the domestic currency. The term “Vostro” means “your account with us.”
- Features of Vostro Account
 - It is maintained by a foreign bank in a domestic bank.
 - The account is held in the domestic country's currency.
 - It enables foreign banks to conduct local transactions.
 - It is used for trade settlements and cross-border payments.
 - Helps in smooth inward remittances and business transactions.
 - Example of Vostro Account: If a US bank maintains an account in an Indian bank like Punjab National Bank in Indian Rupees, it is called a Vostro account for that US bank.

Why is BRICS exploring cross-border payments

- **Working of Cross Border Payments**
 - It travels through a chain of intermediaries called correspondent banks. Since very few banks hold both rupees and rand directly, the payment gets converted rand → dollar → rupee, with the US dollar acting as a “vehicle currency”.
- **SWIFT**
 - Alongside the actual money, payment instructions also need to travel between banks, this is handled by SWIFT (Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication).
 - SWIFT is a Belgium-based cooperative overseen by the National Bank of Belgium and G-10 central banks (including the US Federal Reserve).
 - SWIFT works like a secure messaging network, a “post office” for payment instructions used directly by over 11,000 institutions in more than 200 countries.
 - The Group of Ten (G10 or G-10) refers to the group of 11 countries that agreed to participate in the General Arrangements to Borrow (GAB), an agreement to provide the International Monetary Fund (IMF) with additional funds to increase its lending ability.
 - United States, United Kingdom, Germany, France, Italy, Canada, Japan, Netherlands, Belgium, Sweden, Switzerland

Why is BRICS exploring cross-border payments

- **Issue**

- **For developing economies, heavy reliance on a few dominant currencies mainly the US dollar, euro, and yen creates exposure to the monetary policies of the countries issuing them.**
- **Foreign exchange margins are paid twice: Every intermediary charges a fee, and the two currency conversions mean the exchange margin is taken on both legs.**
- **Sanctions are the sharpest driver and the sharpest deterrent: Several Russian banks were cut off from SWIFT in 2022 following Russia's invasion of Ukraine.**

Why is BRICS exploring cross-border payments

- **Way ahead**

- **Bilateral linkage of national systems:** Two countries can connect their domestic payment systems directly, avoiding correspondent banks and dollar conversion. Eg. India and Singapore have linked the Unified Payments Interface with PayNow for remittances.
- **CBDC settlement on a common platform:** Central banks issue digital versions of their currencies for use between banks, a settlement asset distinct from the retail digital rupee held by individuals, and exchange them on one platform.
- **The BRICS-specific proposal:** The Kazan declaration of 2024 agreed to discuss and study the feasibility of an independent settlement system called BRICS Clear.
- **Project Nexus** is conceptualised by the Innovation Hub of the Bank for International Settlements (BIS). It seeks to enhance cross-border payments by connecting multiple global domestic instant payment systems (IPS).
- **Launched in 2021, mBridge is a cross-border, decentralised, multiple central bank digital currency (mCBDC) platform.** Initially led by the BIS Innovation Hub, in collaboration with the other four central banks of China, Thailand, the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and Hong Kong. Saudi Central Bank joined in 2024.

Dragonflies are bellwethers of earth's ecosystem

Dragonflies are bellwethers of earth's ecosystems



**SPEAKING OF
SCIENCE**

D. Balasubramanian

In the imagination of children, flying holds a special place. Folded pieces of paper become aeroplanes ready to be launched, eager gazes follow soaring eagles, and dragonflies are the helicopters of their fantasies.

Dragonflies (called *sitarā* in Hindi) are indeed wonders of flight. These insects belong to a lineage whose members were among the planet's first flying organisms. About 300 million years ago, their ancient kin had the same aerodynamic features, but with a wingspan that extended to 72 cm. The spectacle of these giant ancestors of dragonflies would have left any modern ob-

server spellbound.

India is home to around 600 species in the order *Odonata*, which includes dragonflies and the slender damselflies. The pages of *The Hindu* sometimes feature colourful pictures of newly discovered Indian species, usually in either the Northeastern States or in the Western Ghats where Karnataka, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu meet. But alas, ecological surveys increasingly report missing dragonfly species and shrinking populations. In a world where public attention is fixated on large mammals, why do these ancient insects merit so much thought?

One notable trait of the *Odonata* is that they split their life cycle, being aquatic in the early stages and terrestrial and aerial as adults. Nymphs, as their larvae are called, live in water – be it in wetlands, ponds or in flowing



A blue hawklet in Silent Valley National Park, Kerala, August 2016.
JEE & RANI NATURE PHOTOGRAPHY (CC BY-SA)

streams. The adults hover, accelerate, and swoop on four independently articulated wings. But in all phases, dragonflies are the dominant insect predators. The nymphs feed on the larvae and pupae of mosquitoes and other insects. One growing dragonfly nymph can finish off a hundred mosquito larvae in a day. In flooded paddy fields, nymphs feed on the aquatic stages of crop pests, while dragonflies prey on leafhoppers and

other damage-causing insects.

That said, dragonflies are sometimes also the prey.

The *Odonata* are themselves susceptible to the actions of pesticides, particularly systemic pesticides such as fipronil. These chemical compounds are absorbed by plants and make the whole plant toxic to insects. So over time, excessive pesticide levels lead to a decline in dragonfly numbers.

Conversely, the presence of a healthy population of dragonflies and their nymphs in agricultural zones is a sign of well-managed farming without excessive pesticide use.

Away from human-dominated landscapes as well, dragonfly populations are affected by a changing planet. Some species in the Western Ghats have evolved to flourish in forests where water seeps from wet, marshy soil into mountain streams. In more recent years, cycles of drought and excessive rainfall have not been kind to several endemic Indian species, such as the blue hawklet (*Hylaeothemis apicalis*), a strikingly colored dragonfly with blue-green eyes, but which is very rarely seen these days.

While looking to dragonflies and damselflies as the bellwethers of our ecosystems, we also continue to unearth new facets of

what makes them unique. Recent research on the eyes that provide 360-degree vision to dragonflies has shown that there are 16 or more genes that code for visual opsins, the proteins that detect colour and light. We humans make do with just four visual opsins: one each for the red, green, and blue colours in our cone cells and a fourth for low-light vision by the rod cells. The molecular abundance gives dragonflies a very sensitive visual system that even perceives ultraviolet light (PNAS 112 (11) E1247-E1256).

Even as their numbers dwindle, these fascinating creatures continue to provide us with new insights.

The article was coauthored with Sushil Chandani, who works in molecular modelling.

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Dragonflies are bellwethers of earth's ecosystem

- **Evolutionary Background** : These insects are among the earliest known flying organisms, originating approximately 300 million years ago.
- **India is home to approximately 600 species** belonging to the order Odonata, which includes both dragonflies and damselflies.
- **Distribution** – There is significant species diversity in the Northeast and Western Ghats regions.
- Recent ecological surveys indicate declining populations and the disappearance of certain species.
- For example, the Blue Hawklet (*Hylaeothemis apicalis*), which is endemic to the Western Ghats, is now rarely observed.
- Adults prey on leafhoppers and other harmful insects.
- These species serve as indicators of healthy ecosystems and sustainable agricultural practices.
- **Threats** – The use of pesticides, particularly systemic compounds such as fipronil, has contributed to a decline in population numbers.
- Climate change has resulted in increased droughts and unpredictable rainfall patterns, which negatively impact endemic species.
- Additionally, these species are subject to predation by various other organisms.
- **Distinctive Biological Characteristics** – The species possesses panoramic vision (360 degree)
- It is capable of detecting ultraviolet light and exhibits a highly sensitive visual system.

What is One Nation One Time

What is 'One Nation, One Time'?

What is the need for a common time reference? How will it work? What do the latest Rules say?

Indriyana Yenni

The story so far: In August 2017, the Centre notified the *Legal Metrology (General) Rules, 2017*, making the Indian Standard Time (IST) the single reference for legal, administrative, commercial, and other official purposes across the country.

"The states will come into force 180 days from the date of their publication in the Official Gazette.... The 180-day period will allow government departments, businesses, institutions and other organizations to make the required changes to their systems before the states come into force," the government said in a statement on August 30.

Why does India need a common time?

The government said the need for a common time reference has increased with the growing use of digital and technology-based systems. Banking and digital payments, telecommunications, railways, power systems, computer networks, and government records depend on accurate time and time stamps. "Differences between time sources can affect the coordination and recording of all activities. The Rules are aimed at ensuring that important systems across the country use accurate and consistent Indian Standard Time," it said.

The common time reference is expected to support accurate time stamping of banking and digital payment transactions, coordination among railways, airports, and other transport systems, reliable functioning of telecommunication and Internet networks, precise time-keeping in power systems, upkeep of government and legal records, and coordination of emergency services.

How did the push for a common time 'begin'?
On January 27, 2025, the Department of Consumer Affairs had notified the Bar Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2025, according to synchronise time across India. It had teamed up with National Physical Laboratory (NPL) and India Space Research Organisation (ISRO) to "disseminate IST with uniformity to all connected networks" from the

BT, according to the government, is based on "Coordinated Universal Time (UTC)" with a "UTC base offset value is maintained by the CSIR National Physical Laboratory (CSIR NPL)." The government said that despite its importance, BT was not mandatorily adopted by all television service providers and internet service providers. It said many of them continued to rely on foreign time sources such as GPS. "Synchronizing all networks and systems to BT is essential for national security, real-time applications and the smooth operation of critical infrastructure," it said.

The government constituted a high-power inter-ministerial committee to formulate a policy framework, legislation, and legislation for the adoption of CIST under the Legal Metrology Act, 1908. Headed by the Secretary, Consumer Affairs, the committee had representatives from NPL, NIST, IIT Kharagpur, the National Information Centre, the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT), the Securities and Exchange Board of India, the railways and telecom departments, among others.

What do the latest sales mean?

According to CSIR-NPL, the frequency of "BIP" had been registered in 2004 but the time was not "regulated" in India. "BIP" is generated using advanced atomic clocks and satellite links to ensure that it is traceable to Coordinated Universal Time (UTC), the international reference time, with an uncertainty of less than 2 nanoseconds. The BIP is widely disseminated with millisecond accuracy with NTP (Network Protocol Service) servers at CSIR-NPL, the

The GPS-NIP, says ISRO, has been "given traceability to DG, with reasonable accuracy" through satellite links to NavIC, India's independent satellite navigation system.

As part of the 'One Nation, One Time' initiative, the government in July 2000 commissioned a White Rabbit Technology Based IP Distribution Demonstration Network at the Regional Reference Standard Laboratory in Bangalore. It used the new system "uphold[s] the sovereignty of the nation's digital infrastructure by eliminating India's reliance on foreign time-servers for GPS". This would provide critical sector "maximum protection" against cyber attacks and data manipulation. The Bangalore pilot demonstrated how ISL could be disseminated across sectors.

(Click again from P10)

What is One Nation One Time

GMT (Greenwich Mean Time) is the historical reference time measured at Greenwich, London, located at 0° longitude. It is based on the mean (average) solar time, meaning the apparent movement of the Sun is averaged to create a uniform measure of time. Since the Earth rotates 360° in about 24 hours, every 15° of longitude corresponds roughly to 1 hour of time difference from Greenwich. Thus, GMT historically served as the reference point for calculating the time of different places around the world.

UTC (Coordinated Universal Time) is the modern international standard of time, primarily based on extremely precise atomic clocks, while being kept closely related to Earth's rotation.

What is One Nation One Time

	GMT	UTC
Based on	Earth's Rotation	Atomic Clocks and Earth's Rotation
Precision	Less precise	Highly Precise

What is One Nation One Time

Indian Standard Time (IST)

Longitudinal Basis: IST is calculated on the basis of the 82.5° E longitude (Standard Meridian).

The 82.5° E meridian passes through five Indian states: Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, and Andhra Pradesh.

Global Offset: IST is exactly 5 hours and 30 minutes ahead of Coordinated Universal Time (UTC +5:30).

The Official Timekeeper: The CSIR-National Physical Laboratory (NPL) in New Delhi is the custodian of IST. It maintains the national time standard using a bank of highly precise Cesium and Rubidium atomic clocks, which are synchronised with the International Bureau of Weights and Measures (BIPM) in France.

What is One Nation One Time

The Department of Consumer Affairs has notified the Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026, establishing Indian Standard Time (IST) as the mandatory, single time reference for all legal, administrative, commercial, and official purposes across India

The rules were notified under Section 52 of the Legal Metrology Act, 2009, giving legal and administrative significance to a uniform national time standard.

Precise IST will be disseminated through domestic infrastructure backed by CSIR-National Physical Laboratory (CSIR-NPL) and Legal Metrology laboratories.

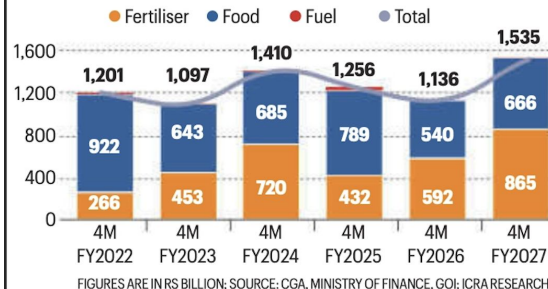
It uses White Rabbit Technology (WRT), commissioned at the Regional Reference Standard Laboratory (RRSL), Bengaluru, to achieve sub-nanosecond-level time synchronisation across institutions such as ISRO, SEBI, NSE and BSNL.

India's Rising Subsidy Bill

• INDIA'S RISING SUBSIDY BILL



India's subsidy bill rose by 35% in the first four months of the ongoing financial year (4MFY27) against the same period last year (4MFY26). It was led by the fertiliser subsidy bill, which shot up by 46.2% amid the ongoing war in West Asia, followed by food subsidies at 23%. The total subsidy bill came in at Rs 1,535 billion, with a miniscule share of subsidy on fuels in it, according to a ICRA report.



Why is the centre opposed to totalisers ?

Why is the Centre opposed to totalisers?

What are totalisers and how do they prevent candidates from determining the voting pattern of individual polling booths? What has been the Centre's position? What does the Election Commission of India believe? What has the Supreme Court said?

Sreeparna Chakrabarty

The story so far:

In September 1, a Supreme Court Bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana asked the Central government to examine the possibility of introducing totaliser machines for counting votes recorded in Electronic Voting Machines (EVM) in order to protect the secrecy of booth-wise voting patterns and prevent electors at individual booths from being identified and potentially victimised.

The case dates back to 2014, when two individuals, Yogesh Gupta and Imran Khan, moved a public interest petition (PIL) seeking a direction to the poll panel to mix votes cast at various polling stations in a constituency to prevent candidates from intimidating voters in places that had rebuffed them.

What is a totaliser?

A totaliser is a proposal aimed at preventing candidates from determining the voting pattern of individual polling booths. A totaliser allows the votes cast in about 14 polling booths to be

The Centre has argued that knowledge of booth-wise vote shares allowed the candidates to work harder in areas where support for them was low

counted together. At present, the votes are tallied booth by booth. It was developed by Bharat Electronics Limited, Bengaluru, and Electronics Corporation of India Limited, Hyderabad.

A totaliser is an interface connected to the main control unit of a cluster of 14 EVMs. Pressing the result button on the totaliser gives the consolidated votes polled by each candidate across the 14 EVMs, without revealing the voting pattern of individual polling areas.

Why was the petition seeking totalisers filed in the Supreme Court?

Gupta and Khan had moved a PIL, seeking a direction to the poll panel to mix up the votes cast in the various polling stations in a constituency. They said that it was necessary to prevent the candidates from intimidating voters in areas that had rebuffed them.

As part of their arguments, the duo gave the example of the alleged intimidation by late former Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister, Ajit Pawar, in the Baramati constituency during the last general election. Pawar had allegedly threatened the voters that his party, the Nationalist Congress Party, would be able to detect voting patterns from the EVM readings and cut off their water supply if they snubbed it.

Booths in India are generally marked geographically. If there are social groups that are segregated or living in clusters, which is the case in many parts of rural India (and increasingly in urban slums as well), it is possible to roughly identify if a particular community that is numerically large in an area with a specific polling booth or station has voted in a certain direction. With the advent of advanced geospatial tools, it is even easier today to not only correlate polling booth trends and social settings but also draw causal insights. This was the fear expressed by the petitioners in 2014.

What has been the stand of the Central government?

The Centre has always opposed totalisers. In 2017, the Centre had told the apex court that

identifying booth-wise voting patterns did not lead to voter intimidation and that there was no need to stop the disclosure of booth-wise results. It argued that knowledge of booth-wise vote shares allowed the candidates to work harder in areas where support for them was low, thus producing better results for everyone involved.

In 2018, Additional Solicitor General Maninder Singh told the Bench, which was led by then CJI Dipak Misra, that installing a totaliser could lead to data breach even before vote counting began.

More recently, the Centre again raised the same apprehension. This prompted the Court to give the Election Commission two weeks to respond to this fear.

A Law Ministry affidavit told the Court that a group of ministers headed by the then Home Minister Rajnath Singh had decided last September that "intimidation/victimisation of voters as apprehended may not occur on a larger scale in this era of media activism".

What has been the Election Commission's stand?

The Election Commission has been consistently supportive of introducing totalisers. It first suggested the measure to the United Progressive Alliance government in 2008. In a 2018 submission before the Supreme Court, the poll body stated that "a time has come for introduction of totaliser for counting of the votes." That support has continued into the current round of hearings. The poll body informed the Court that it had earlier recommended the totaliser system to the Union government. The senior advocate representing the Election Commission backed the goal of protecting voter anonymity, while also flagging some practical and legal challenges in actually implementing the proposal, including concerns around booth-wise verification and VVPAT.

What has the Supreme Court said now?

The Supreme Court asked the Central government to state its position on introducing a totaliser system for counting votes recorded through EVMs. The Court specifically sought to know if there are any impediments to introducing such a mechanism and if there would be any negative impact because of it. The Election Commission has also been asked to submit its proposal to the government.



File photo of women waiting in queue to exercise their franchise for the local body election at a polling booth in Erode, Tamil Nadu. N. GOVINDHAN

Why is the centre opposed to totalisers ?

Benefits

Masking Booth Trends: By pooling the results, it eliminates individual, booth-by-booth vote tallies. Because polling booths in India are organized geographically, individual booth counts make it easy to identify how specific neighborhoods, villages, or demographic clusters voted. Totalisers effectively obscure these micro-level voting patterns.

Issues

Targeted Governance: Booth-level results help representatives identify areas needing greater development and welfare attention.

Limited Risk of Victimisation: The Centre argues that widespread voter intimidation is unlikely amid strong media and public scrutiny.

Technical Concerns: Linking totalisers may require de-sealing EVMs, creating potential security and data-leak risks.

Thank You